RETROSPECTIVE ▼

TRACING A DECADES-LONG JOURNEY

Delhi's Chawla Art Gallery will soon host a major retrospective of the sculptor K.S. Radhakrishnan

The veteran sculptor K.S. Radhakrishnan's recent works suggest a strong sense of vertigo, of people trying to make sense of a disorienting situation. Take the 2025 work 'Boat Over the Milestone' (bronze, 79x27x18 inches), for example, where a boat precariously balances on top of an ordinary milestone. Or 'Crossing the Pitfall' (bronze, 43x27x27 inches), where a group of people are helping each other across a cavernous, hollowed-out monolith.

"You see, the pitfall in any situation is usually visible to everybody," says the 70-year-old sculptor. "But what we make of that pitfall is important and in the sculpture, you observe that it is only possible to cross, to avoid the fall, if you have others helping you across, showing you what to do."

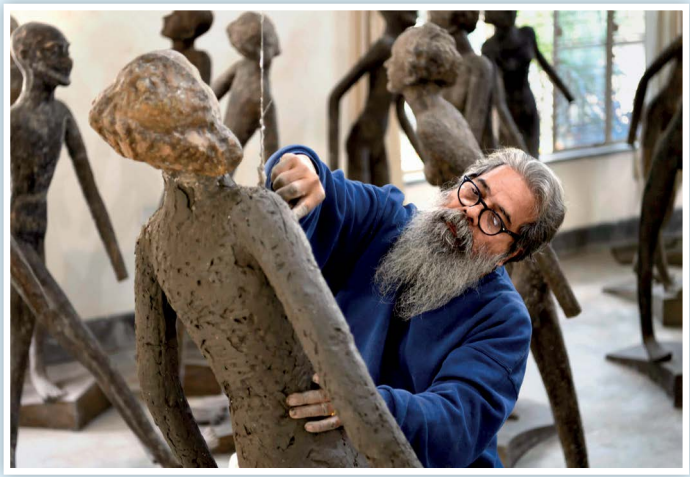
These works are part of *Once Upon a Sculptor* at Delhi's Chawla Art Gallery, an upcoming exhibition that looks back at Radhakrishnan's long and distinguished career, phase by phase. The gallery's director, Shibani Chawla, is also this exhibition's curator.

According to the 70-year-old sculptor, an artist is "always learning and always observing", regardless of the stage of life

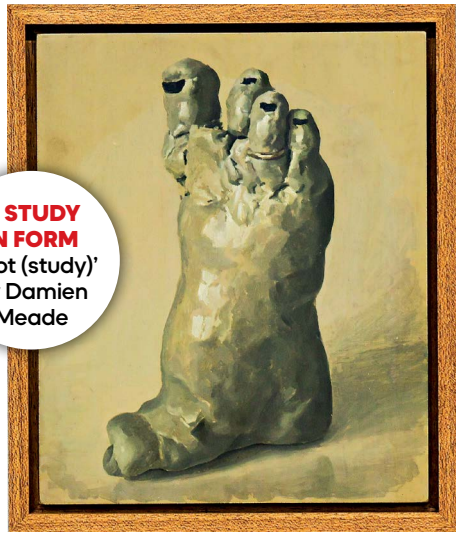
"An artist is always learning, always observing at any stage of their life," adds Radhakrishnan. "When I look back at my career so far there have been many moments that changed the way I look at things. A few years ago, during the making of my large-scale work 'The Crowd', I had to arrange 50 life-sized human figures in a specific way." The whole experience, he recalls, taught him "a lot about perspective and how people see each other".

—Aditya Mani Jha

On view at Chawla Art Gallery in Saket, Delhi, from Mar. 18 till Apr. 30



LIFE CAST IN METAL
K.S. Radhakrishnan working on his large-scale work 'The Crowd' (2023)



A STUDY IN FORM
'Foot (study)' by Damien Meade

EXHIBITION ▼

FOREIGN WINDS

An exhibition of European artists shows India's growing interest in international art

Thapar Contemporary is currently hosting *The Engineering of Rubble*, a group exhibition of 11 contemporary European artists, which explores themes of fragmentation, imperfection and endurance through drawings, sculptures, paintings, photography, video and sound works. Artists featured include Sarah Staton, a British sculptor known for large-scale public commissions; Charo Garaigorta, a Spanish-American multidisciplinary artist; and Damien Meade, an Irish artist whose 2009 work 'Foot (study)' was inspired by a cremation he saw in Varanasi in 2006.

THE EXHIBITION **EXPLORES THE THEMES OF** FRAGMENTATION, IMPERFECTION AND ENDURANCE

"The idea of using rubble as a starting point for curating the exhibition emerged from long-term conversations with artists and my ongoing interest in themes of movement and creativity," says curator Jasone Miranda-Bilbao. "Rubble became a metaphor for transformation." Does an exhibition of this scale suggest a market for contemporary European art in India? "Many first-time buyers," Jasone notes, "view pieces by European artists alongside Indian ones to build diverse, prestigious collections." ■

—Amit Dixit

On view at Thapar Contemporary, Kapashera, Delhi, till Apr. 4